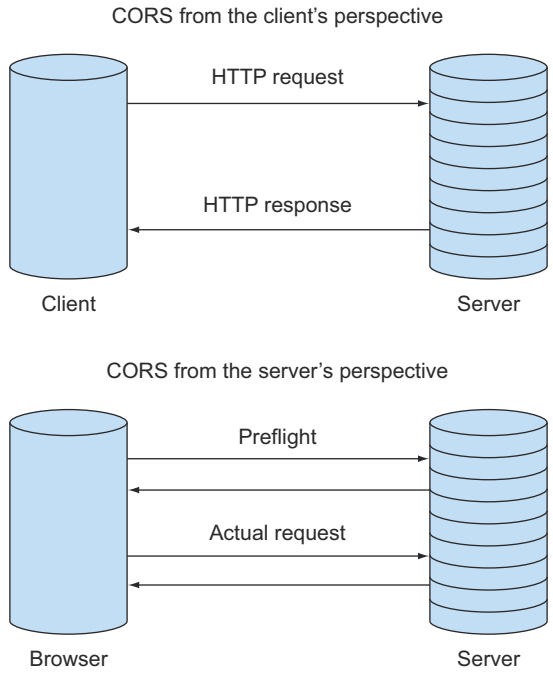


Figure 4.20 A CORS request (with preflight) looks like a regular HTTP request from the client's perspective.

request, but only the server developer needs to worry about this complexity. From the client developer's perspective, a cross-origin request looks the same as any HTTP request.

PREFLIGHTS ARE STATELESS

Both the preflight and the actual request are stateless. This means that there is no additional information connecting the actual request back to the preflight request that preceded it. To get a sense of what this means, table 4.7 compares a preflight request with its partner request.

Table 4.7 The actual request has no information about the preflight request

Request type	HTTP request

Preflight	`OPTIONS /api/posts HTTP/1.1`
	`User-Agent: Chrome`
	`Host: 127.0.0.1:9999`
	`Accept: */*`
	`Origin: http://localhost:1111`
	`Access-Control-Request-Method: GET`
	`Access-Control-Request-Headers: Timezone-Offset, Sample-Source`

Actual	`GET /api/posts HTTP/1.1`
	`User-Agent: Chrome`
	`Host: 127.0.0.1:9999`
	`Accept: */*`
	`Origin: http://localhost:1111`
	`Timezone-Offset: 300`
	`Sample-Source: Cors in Action`